

Primary Source Analysis Assignment

Primary sources are an important tool that historians use to learn more about what life was like in the past. For this assignment you will be analyzing a letter from World War 2. Follow the “I can” statements below to complete this assignment.

I can complete the primary source vs secondary source check in.

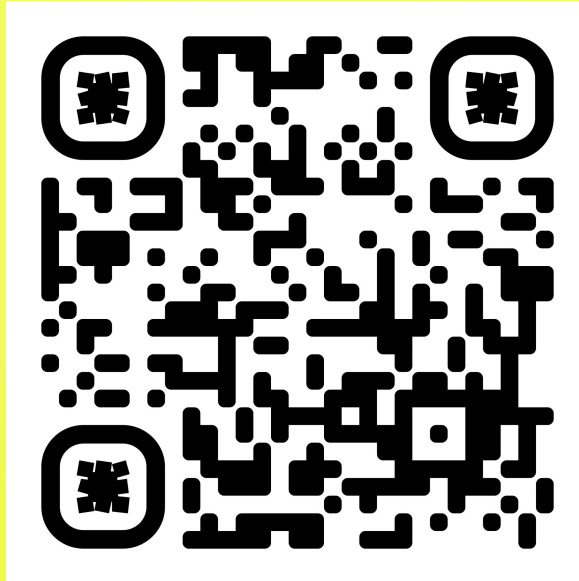
I can make notes on the contents of the letter, identifying any key information about the soldiers experience.

I can present the information from my notes in a clear and creative manner and turn into our Google Classroom.

Learning Goal: To understand the difference between primary and secondary sources.

Primary Source vs Secondary Source Check In

Before analyzing the primary source document it is first important to understand the difference between a primary source and a secondary source. Click on or scan the QR Code to complete the check in quiz.



[CLICK HERE OR SCAN TO COMPLETE QUIZ](#)

Primary Source Notes

Now that you understand the difference between primary and secondary sources it is time to analyze and make notes on our primary source document. Make notes to the best of your ability on the contents of the letter. Here are some things to keep in mind when creating your notes:

- You do not need to write every word down word for word
- Focus on important details about what the individual was going through or events described in it
- Pay attention for any names, dates, locations (if there are any mentioned)
 - References to other individuals and their experiences

[Link to full PDF or the Primary Source Letter](#)

Somewhere in Italy
June 3/44

Dear Sister
Just a line to let you
know i am well and hope
this will find you all
the same i received the
cigarettes you sent me some
time ago and thanks a lot
i had a letter from annie
last week and also had
a parcel from Margaret
and the folks any mail
been a long time getting
to me for i am in a
different regt know i
was in Hospital in November
for fifteen days i got
a slight wound in the
leg but it got better quick
i guess you hear all the

Notes:

Location: Somewhere in Italy (Cut off at the top)

news from over here and
 we giving the Jerries hell
 a head uncle Dave died
 i guess i will see a lot
 of changes when i get back
 but i expect to get back
 soon i think it will soon
 be over and i been ducking
 the shells very good so far
 one of my churns got killed
 before christmas and another
 one i used to churn around
 with in England was taken
 prisoner he belonged to Halifax
 i felt bad about them
 for they was two of my best
 friends the one got killed i
 was taking to him about
 ten minutes before and
 gave him a pkg of cigarettes

Notes:

and just was a little distance
when a shell came over and
killed him. I seen a lot
of the world since I left
home and seen a lot of
things happen but I guess
I am one of the lucky ones
so far I guess the Red and
rum is pretty scarce over
there I was in one building
here where there was five
thousand gallons of wine
we used to shoot holes through
the barrels with a rifle and
sample them all to see
what ones was the best
I had some drunk for
a few days till I hear
it not much news love to
all from your loving brother
Pte 730144 Pte. Robert MacPherson
No 3 Motor group, S.I. I
1st Canadian Division overseas

Notes:

230144 Private Robin Richards
No 3 Motor Group S/LI
first Canadian Division
C.M.F.

Notes:

Presenting Your Findings

Now that you have completed taking notes on the contents of the primary source it is time to present your findings. Using the information from the notes you took on the primary source, present your findings and what you learned from your analysis of the source. When it comes to presenting your finds you can:

Create a slideshow

Write an essay about your findings

Create a video analyzing the primary source and present your findings

Record a podcast in a small group discussing what you learned from the letter

Create a storyboard or comic to present your findings

Visual or Digital Representation

When finished make sure you submit your notes and final product to our google classroom.

Sources:

Reading for check in:

Whitfield, Kathryn L. . A Changing Canada . Edited by Jill Colyer, Rubicon, 2021.

Primary Source Letter:

Special thank your to Ms Cheryl and her family for sharing this piece of family history to make this assignment possible.